

THE
Charitable Pestmaster,
OR,
The cure of the
PLAGUE

By THOMAS SHERVVOOD *Practitioner in*
PHYSICK.

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE CHARITABLE PESTMASTER; OR,
THE CURE OF THE PLAGUE ***

THE
Charitable Pestmaster,
OR,
The cure of the
P L A G U E,

Conteining a few fhort and necessary
instructions how to preserve the body from
infection of the P L A G V E , as alfo to
cure thofe that are Infected.

*Together with a little treatife concerning
the cure of the Small Pox.*

Publiſhed for the benefit of the poore of this City and
not unmeet for the Rich,

By T H O M A S S H E R W O O D *Practitioner in*
P H Y S I C K .

2 Kings 20.7.

*And I S A I A H faid, take a lump of Figs, and they tooke, and
laid it upon the boil, and he recovered.*

LONDON
Printed by A.N. for *John Francklin*, and are to be fold
at his Shop in *Lothbury*, neer the
Windmill. 1641.



To the Worshopfull *Alexander*
Read, Doctor of Physick and
 Chirurgery, one of the Societie of
 the Colledge of Physicians for
 the Citie of *London*.

S*ir*, having finished this treatise, I considered what entertainment it might find in the world; and fearing, that it would be envied, for the good that it offereth unto this Kingdome, as I the Author have been for my practice, I bethought my selfe that it might safely hover under your wings, whereupon I am bold to thrust it into your protection, that it may the better be defended from the calumnies of these times. The Subject of it is, that which I have practised and proved by Experience, so that if there bee occasion, I believe I shall bee able to render sufficient reasons to prove it, from the most Authentique rules in Physick. And if there be any errors escaped in it, I shall rather desire that they may be corrected by the discretiō of you or any of the Colledg of Physicians, than disputed upon by new beginners in the practice of Physick, who have but small experience. As for those Medicines published at the latter end of this booke, I shall not desire your protection for them, because I never made you, nor any man acquainted with them. For I intended that they should be Protectors for themselves: but however I hope that my endeavours in this small treatise will not be unpleasant, but acceptable to you, for the good which I believe it will do in the World; and so for this time I rest in some measure of assurance of your worships favour.

Your Servant,
 THO: SHERWOOD.



To the friendly Reader.

Having considered with my selfe in these dangerous times the great distresses of the poore of this City, by reason of the contagious disease of the pestilence, now reigning amongst them; and seeing them to be altogether ignorant, in the use of those meanes that are convenient for their cure, as purging, vomiting, bleeding, sweating, and the like: Therefore considering what good these few rules (experimented by my selfe) may do unto many, I was thereby moved to print them, for the benefit of such who want the helpe of the skilfull and faithfull Phylician. For the understanding and memory of those that shall have occasion to use them, I have divided them into three Chapters, with contents. As for the medicines prescribed, they are sold by Apothecaries, who may afford them reasonably to the poore: The others adjoyned I shall give to the poore for Gods sake, and the rich shall have them for competent satisfaction; but I shall esteeme it my greatest reward, if any shall receive good and benefit by my small labours and endeavours.

Thine T. S.





C H A P . 1 .

1. *What are the causes of the Pestilence.* 2. *How they are avoided.* 3. *Means to preserve the body from Infection.*



Here are divers causes of this disease. The first is sin, which ought to be repented of. The second an infected and corrupted air, which should be avoided. The third an evill diet, which should be amended. The fourth are evill humours heaped together in the body, being apt to putrifie, and beget a Fever, which must be taken away by convenient medicines.

Therefore whosoever would preserve their bodies from infection, let them first make their peace with God, in whose hand is the power of life and death. Then let them use the meanes, and shun all those things that are able to beget this disease, as all infected and corrupted aire, all fogges and mists that do arise from the earth or water, and all stinking smells that do arise from dunghills, sinks, graves, carrion, snuffs of candles, or rotten fruits, or any thing else that doth putrifie and stink. Abstain from all meats and drinks that beget rottenesse and filthinesse in the body (& so consequently a Fever or the Plague) as excessive eating of fruits, especially those that are unripe. Also forbear all sorts of fish that have neither scales nor shels, as Eels, Lampreys, and the like. Lastly, take heed of over-charging the stomacke with meats, or drinks, or hot Wines; but especially your unripe medium Wines.

If any shall find themselves oppressed with gross & corrupt humors, so that they are in danger of this disease they shall be cleansed, by taking one ounce and half, or two ounces, of the infusion *Crocus metallorum*, (which is to be bought at every Apothecaries) & put to it *Oximel* half an ounce, this shall give them five or six vomits, and almost as many stools. And after every vomit, let them drinke some warme posset drinke; so let them keepe themselves warme that day: one houre after it hath done working let them eat a messe of warm broth made with a neck of Mutton, or with such fresh meat as the sick are best able to buy; of which meat let them eat sparingly for the present. Those that are so tender or weakly that they cannot brook this vomit, they may be very well purged from corrupt humours, by taking one or two drams of *pilula Pestilenciales*: But the poorer sort that cannot goe to this charge, may take instead thereof *Aloes* one dram in the pap of an Apple, stewed Prunes, or else in a little Ale or Beere. This pill, and this *Aloes*, are excellent remedies for women and children, and they are so safe that women with child may take them. After the bodie is purged, it shall be necessary to draw six or eight ounces of blood from the liver or middle vein of the arme, if the partie be able to sustain the losse of it.

Such as have lived temperatly and sparingly, and so consequently are not oppressed with corrupted humours, such shall not need any the aforelaid evacuations or purgations; but let them shun, as much as they can, all infectious and corrupted aire: But seeing it is a thing almost impossible in the Citie of *London*; therefore they that are timorous and fearefull may carry about them the roots of *Enula campana*, and *Angelica*, dried or candied, of which they may bite now and then. Also the waters of *Scabios*, *Angelica*, or *Pimpernell*, are great preservations for children against the Plague, if two spoonfuls thereof be taken in a morning fasting.

C H A P . 2 .

1 By what signes you may know whether the sick be infected with the Pestilence. 2 How those signes doe encrease or decrease every day; 3 Whether life or death be likely to ensue; 4 A caveat not to tamper with those that begin to amend of themselves.

THose that are infected with the Pestilence, in the beginning or first day thereof, are taken with an extraordinary cold outwardly, and a burning heate inwardly, a great paine and girding about the stomacke, a sluggishnesse and drouinesse of the whole body, a losse of appetite, a bitternesse in the throat, with a desire to vomit, & sometimes they do vomit.

The disease continuing unto the second and third day, the heate breaketh outwardly, stronger, and stronger, so that there followeth a great paine in the head, and a difficulty of breathing, superfluous sleeps, and sometimes superfluous watchings, they grow frantike and light-headed, and they looke very strangely: And if there doth any swelling appear under the eares, armes, cheeks, or groines, and that these signes aforementioned doe begin to cease, Then shall the sick recover immediatly without any medicine, onely give him a plaster or pultesse to ripen the tumour, which must be applyed the next day after the swelling appeareth; but give him nothing inwardly, except it be a warme Caudle, or Ale-brue, or Broth; for if you give him a vomit or purge, you shall strike the swelling into the noble parts, and the sick shall be in danger of his life: and if you let him bloud, you shall draw the venemous humour from the Soare into the veins, and disperse it with the bloud through the whole body, and thereby destroy the health of the patient, and shorten his life; as it came to passe with a good friend of mine. Also if you give him any medicine to provoke sweat, you shall restore the Fever again, and so the sicke shall die without redemption; yea, and more miserably, then those that never amended, unlesse God be more mercifull unto him; whereof I have had a sorrowfull experience.

Therefore bee carefull that you doe not tamper with those that do begin to amend: for those very Medicines that are excellently available against any Fevers in the beginning or encrease of them, being given in the declination or recovery, will bring the patient into a Relapse, which is worse then the former disease, and which shall greatly endanger life. For how many have died by the unseasonable taking of Treacle, Mithridate, and other good Medicines? Wherefore I have often said, that a skilfull Phyfician by watching his time shall doe more with a cup of warme drinke in the cure of the Plague, or any Fever, then the ignorant shall do with all the excellent Medicines that are in the Apothecaries Shop.

Now if the riling doe appear, & that the symptoms or signes aforenamed doe not begin to ceafe, but rather encrease, Then shortly after there will appeare some blains or spots, & so death ensueth, unlesse you draw ten or twelve ounces of bloud (according to the strength of the sick) from the liver or middle vein of the arme, on that side where the riling is.

But if so be that the sicknesse continueth unto the third and fourth day, and the symptoms remaine in their full vigour, then shortly will the spots come forth; and then I know no medicine that can deliver from death, except God be more mercifull to the sick: But only on the third day before the spots appear it shall be greatly available to give him one of the cordial sweats prescribed in the ensuing Chapter.

CHAP. 3.

1 Here are prescribed certain approved remedies for the cure of the Pestilence, 2 The order and manner how to use them.

WHosoever shall perceive their bodies infected with the Plague, let them take on the first day of the sicknesse the vomit, in that order and manner as it is laid down in the first Chapter. And after it hath done working with them, they shall find themselves as well as ever they were in their lives: for it cleanseth the stomach and bowels from all corrupt humours, which is one of the chiefest causes of the sickness. But if the sick be weak and cannot bear a vomit, it shall be good to give him one dram of the foresaid *pillulæ pestilenciales*, or instead thereof one dram of *Aloes*, you may give it either in pill or in potion, according as the sick can best take it, and in the working of it let him drink some warm broth.

But if it be so, that this course hath been neglected the first day, or beyond the time of 24 houres, it will be in vaine to use it the second day: Yea, it will be dangerous, seeing that the infection is dispersed by the blood throughout all the Veines of the bodie. Therefore on the second day of Visitation it shall be good to draw from the Median Veine of the arme so much blood as the patient can endure to bleed: and if the sick hath not gone to the stoole during the time of his sicknesse, you shall give him either before or after bleeding this Clyster. *Take of Beets, Violet leaves, Burrage, Buglosse, Scabios, of each one handfull, French barley one ounce; boyle all these in a sufficient quantitie of water untill it be halfe consumed, then strain it, and take three quarters of a pint of the decoction, and put to it of the Electuary of Hierapicra five or sixe drams, oile of Rue one dram, red Sugar one ounce, the yolk of an egge, and a little salt; so make you a Clyster thereof and administer it bloud warme. Also you may administer to the sick this Clyster. Boyle an handfull of Rue in a pint of posset drinke, and put to it a piece of sweet butter, a little honey, the yolke of an egge, and a thimble full of salt; make a clyster and administer it bloud warme.*

But if that the sick amend not upon this course taken the second day, or that this means hath not been used, but that hee continued sick untill the third and fourth day, so that the infection hath taken hold of the vitall spirits, Then keeping him warme in his bed, you shall use this Cordiall to sweat with all. *Take of the water of Scabios, Burrage, Buglosse, and Angelica, of each halfe an ounce, the Electuary of egges two scruples, or one dram, of Bole Armoniak one scruple,*

Syrup of Roses halfe an ounce, make it into a potion, and let the sick drink it up at once or twice: two or three spoonfuls hereof is sufficient for a child. Or the poorer sort may take two penny-worth of Treacle or Mithridate, in a quarter of a pint of Dragon water. With either of these Medicines you may sweat the sick, untill some tumour doth appeare, or that he cometh to know himselfe amended. For this is the last medicinall refuge we have in the cure of the Plague. If you can, keep the sick from drinking and sleepeing for the space of three houres untill the medicine hath done working. But if you cannot, let the patient drinke a little Limon posset, made with some Marigold flowers, and Harts horn.

And if signes of amendment doe appeare, doe not take him out of his bed, or let him coole suddenly: But let him sweate on gently of his own accord, for it is nature sweats following the medicine, which will doe him more good than a Kingdome. In this last sweate you may give him some Caudle or Alebrue: & when the sweats begin to cease of themselves, & his skin grows dry and warme, then let him sit up by a good fire; Aire his cloathes, and so let him give God thanks for his life.

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Adde, if any tumour appeare you may ripen it with this Emplaster. *Take six figs, raisins of the Sun stoned half an ounce, salt two drams, honey one ounce, beat them all together, and heat it well with some oile of Camomill upon the fire, so spread it upon some cloth,* and lay it warm to the tumour, shifting it every twelve houres untill it look with a white head: and when it is ripe, if it be difficult to break, lay to it some Goose dung made warme with some sweet butter or fallet oile; also the root of a white Lilly roasted, with some sorrell, to which put a piece of sweet butter, & apply it very warm to the soare, But if it will not break with this means, then you must open it with a penknife or lancet; else the corruption will rot the flesh, even to the very bone, and when you have opened it, squeeze out the corruption with your hands, and put into the soare, a tent made with *unguentum basilicon*, or *Ægyptiacum*, & *mel rosarum*, and lay upon the tent a plaster made with *Diachilon*: Continue your tents untill all the corruption be drawn out, then the plaster of *Diachilon* will cure it perfectly.

If any that are ancient or weak shall be infected with the Pestilence, it shall not be necessary to give them any purge, vomit, or sweate, or to let them bloud; because they cannot beare the losse of so many spirits as are spent by such evacuations. Therefore you may lay upon the pit of the stomack of the sicke a young live puppy, and if the sick can but sleep the space of three or foure houres, they shall recover presently, and the dog shall die of the Plague. This I have known approved; and I do believe that it will be a cure for all leane, spare, and weake bodies both yong and old: provided, that the dog be yonger then the sick.



Certain Instructions for the cure of the Small Pox.

THe nature of the Smal Pox disperfed this yeer throughout many parts of this Kingdome, I have found to bee more malignant, then any that have reigned in my remembrance; fo that many of all ages and fexes, but efpecially children have miferably died of them: becaufe for the moft part, the peftilence is joynd with them, as it doth plainly appeare by thofe fpoats, blains, and rifings, that follow them. I have likewise obferved that thofe medicines, as *Mithridate*, *Treacle*, *Saffron* and the like, that formerly have cured the fmall Pox, now availe nothing: yea, they are dangerous, if inwardly taken (efpecially if the Patient hath been long fick) but if they be outwardly applyed, as I fhall fhew eft-foons, they will prove good remedies at this time. But how many a tender hearted mother have I feen that, out of an unhappie care of her ficke childe, hath by rafh counfel & the unfeafonable giving to it hot cordiall medicines, encreafed the Fever, multiplyed the matter of the fmall pox, and inflamed the Spirits, fo that the Peftilence hath many times followed. But howfoever the child hath beene incurable, which otherwife if nothing at all, or elfe fome fmall thing of little ftrength, had been adminiftred, might have recovered; whereupon I obferved the fundry ways and meanes practifed by Phyfitians, women, and my felfe, and feeing the diverfe events of them, I laboured to find out a certain and fecure way for the cure of this difeafe; which having found by experience I have (together with this treatife of the Plague) fent it to the Preffe, hoping that no man will either hate mee, or envie mee, for doing good, and that thofe that find benefit by it will thank me for it.

The Primitive or externall caufes of the Small Pox are all one with thofe which are of the Plague, as an evill and corrupted aire, a diforderly dyet, that begets fuffets; as alfo for the antecedent caufes which are corrupt humours heaped together in the body: therefore thofe meanes that I have prefcribed in the firft Chapter to preferve the bodie from the infection of the Plague, they will alfo bee a meanes to preferve from the Small Pox. Thofe that are taken fick this yeere with the Small Pox are affected after the fame manner as thofe that are infected with the peftilence, & in the beginning it can fcarcely be difcerned by an expert Phyfitian from it, But only by thefe fignes.

Thofe that are infected by the fmall Pox are not fo violently affected with heat and cold, nor pains in the ftomack and head, as thofe that are fick with the Peftilence.

Moreover, thofe that will have the fmall Pox their skin is puft up, and blown like a bladder, fo that their face and eyes doe fhine: they have a great itching in

many parts of their bodies, but chiefly about their Nose; they yawn much, also they finde a great paine and heaviness in their back bone.

11

Now if you shall perceive by these signes, that the sick will have the small Pox, keep him warm, but not too hot; neither let him take cold; but give him breathing room enough, as he lyeth in his bed: Then lay a plaister of Mithridate or Treacle to the pit of his stomack, and if hee be at mans estate, let him drinke up all this Cordiall by two or three spoonfuls at a time every houre; but if it be a child, the one halfe will be sufficient. *Take of the waters of Roses, Burrage, Buglosse, and Treacle-water, of each an ounce & half, of the syrrop of Limons, and Clove-gilly-flowers of each one ounce, mix them together, and make thereof a potion:* Also the poorer sort may take *Roses, Burrage, Carduus, Marigold Flowers, and Harts horn, of each a like quantitie, and boyle them in posset drinke, turned with a Limon, or white wine:* for one above twenty yeers of age let him drink three quarters of a pint at severall times, sweetned with Sugar; and for a child halfe the quantitie will suffice. Let the sick sweat gently with either of these Medicines so long as hee can well endure it: for the longer the better; seeing the Medicines of themselves are no violent sweats; & during the sweat you may give him now and then to quench his thirst a very little Limon posset-drink by it self. If he can you may let him sleep whilst he sweateth. And if hee lie quiet during the sweat, by Gods blessing, within the space of eight or ten houres at the most, he shall find himself finely recovered of his sickness. Then give him no more of his Cordial or sweating posset drink, but only of his Limon-posset drink, if he be thirsty; but let him lie warm in his bed til his skin grow dry, then shortly after the Pox will begin to shew themselves. But they will not bee many although every one of them will be far greater then the small Pox do use to be; yet none of them will pit except they be much tampered withal, or picked with the nails. But if so be that those which have white heads do burn and rage extreemly, you may prick their heads with a Needle and let out the corruption: there is nothing else to be done with those upon whom they are come out, and the Fever abated but that they keepe themselves warm, sit still and be quiet.

12

But if that the sick hath not gone to stool in a long time: before you give him this Cordiall to sweat, you shall cause him to goe to stoole by a clyster, or else which is better by a Suppositor made with Honey and Salt, or a Violet Comfit. And if the sicke bee yong, strong, and full of blood, you shall without danger doe very well, if you draw from him eight or ten ounces of blood before you lay him to sweat; for then the Cordiall will have more power, room, and liberty, to play upon the disease, and will the sooner and better drive out the Pox. If the *quintessentia vitae* be given in the waters of Roses, Burrage, or Buglosse, it will drive out the small Pox without sweating, and cure the sick immediatly.

But if the small Pox be come forth, and that the Fever continue in his full vigour still, so that the sick doth not amend, but grow worse and worse, then you shall not give them any hot Medicines inwardly, nor any thing that doth provoke sweat; for now hot cordiall Medicines will encrease the Fever (and in the beginning they would have quenched the Fever) and turn all the humours of the body into the matter of the small Pox; so that there is nothing but a miserable death likely to follow, oftentimes accompanied with the Pestilence.

13

This evill is much practised by those women that pretend they wil drive the small Pox further out, when they are come out already. Wherefore they do but beget

the Fever again, and where there are but ten they will make a thousand. Therefore be carefull in this case, what you do, and give to the sick every hower nothing else but two or three spoonefulls of Rose water, sweetened with a little sugar. This will coole the body, quench the Fever, cause rest, and then a stoole, and thereby the sick shall recover presently. By these meanes I have cured many very suddenly that have been dangerously sick in all mens sight even to Death, as many in the City can beare mee witnesse.

As I have warned you not to give many hot things when the small Pox are come forth, so I would have you beware of giving those that are very cold, as the waters of Plantane, Letice, Purflane, Poppy, and the like; which (as I have Knowne) have relieved many for the present, and wrought an admirable cure in the sight of the common people; but by their cold qualities, they have so congealed and fetled the humours in the body, that the sick will never be healthfull all the daies of their lives, as I could instance in many.

Those that desire further information concerning any particulars not expressed at large in this brief Treatise, they shall be fully satisfied, if they repaire to the Author living in Honey-suckle Court in Grub-street, where he hath by Chemicall Art prepared fix Catholicall Medicines, with which hee cureth the Pestilence, small Pox, and most curable diseases whatsoever.

1 Vomitivum Benedictum.

This Medicine being taken from five graines to eight, in some convenient distilled water or wine, or else with some Conserve or Pill, doth safely purge upwards and downwards, so that it may be given to a Childe, of three or foure yeeres of age: it cureth all diseases that arise from the foulness of the stomach, and is good in the beginning of the Pestilence, small Pox, or any Fever, or Ague.

2 Catharticum Catholicum.

The dose of it is from ten grains to twenty, it purgeth gently by stoole, and cleanseth the lower belly from all offensive humours, & cureth the French Pox, Scurvy, Jaundis, and Dropsie, also it freeth children from Worms.

3 Diureticum Aperitivum.

This openeth all obstructions of the body, but chiefly of the Liver, Spleen, Reines, and Bladder, it cureth the Jaundis and the Rickets in children, also it helpeth those that cannot make water.

4 Diaphoreticum Cordiale.

This being given in a small dose doth gently provoke sweat, expelleth all venomous humours from the heart outwardly, and driveth out the small Pox, thrusteth out the tumours in the Pestilence, and some it cureth without bringing forth a Rising.

5 Quinta Essentia vitæ.

This reviveth the vitall spirits, and hath an admirable vertue in fortifying the heart against all infectious, & venomous vapours; so that it is good for those that have occasiõ to visit sick people. If ten or twelve drops thereof be taken in a mornings draught it preserveth the body from infection, and if twenty or thirty drops of it bee given to the sicke of the Pestilence, within the space of fixe houres after they are infected, they shall be cured in one hour, as I have often proved: it driveth out the small Pox, and cureth the sick without sweating.

6 Iulapium Restaurativum.

By the vertue this Medicine hath in refifting the putrifaction of humours, it doth cure all forts of Fevers and Agues, it may be given in any time of the difeafe, but efpecially in the latter end of the fickneffe, when no other Medicine can be adminiftred without danger. With it I have cured the Hectick Fever, and thofe that have faln into the Relapfe of the fmall Pox, and fuch as have been nigh unto death, by reafon of violent Fevers.

Any of the aforefaid Medicines, the Author adminiftreth both outwardly and inwardly in many feveral wayes and manners, according to the age, temperature, complexion, and difpofition, of the bodie; and according to the nature, degrees, and time of the difeafe.

*Artis Apollineæ vis fola eft numen Olympi,
Quo fine languenti Pharmaca frustra dabis.*

If that our art from God receive not ftrength,
In vain we feek mans life for to prolenght.

FINIS.

Transcriber's Note

Four typographical errors have been corrected: "Scabies" replaced by "Scabios", "for for" by "for", "Safforn" replaced by "Saffron", and "harh" by "hath".

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE
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